Pietro Pellerito

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Fields of Interest

Labor, Public, Economics of Education

Education

Ph.D. Economics, University of Notre Dame — May 2027 (exp.)
M.A. Economics, University of Notre Dame — July 2022
B.S. Applied Mathematics, Kettering University (Minor - Economics) — June 2021

Job Market Paper

"Breaking Boundaries: Competitive Effects of Inter-District School Choice"

Abstract: Expanding school choice can incentivize school districts to improve educational quality as they compete for enrollment. When students exercise that choice, however, changes in student composition and district resources make its overall effect on educational quality uncertain. I exploit an Indiana property-tax reform that incidentally eliminated fees to attend public schools outside a student's residential district. Using statewide administrative data, I measure the extent to which each school district's enrollment is threatened, comparing its pre-reform achievement with that of neighboring districts. I find that districts facing greater enrollment pressure improve educational quality, narrowing pre-existing achievement gaps with neighboring districts by 5.3 percent overall and 8.4 percent in elementary grades. Gains are largest in smaller districts, where enrollment losses are harder to absorb. These findings show that expanding access to non-residential public schools can improve educational quality even for students who remain enrolled in their home district.

Working Papers

"Staying Connected: Experimental Effects of Weekly Text Messages in an Adult High School"
with Patrick Turner and Alberto Ortega

Selected Works in Progress

"Firm Behavior to Dual Minimum Wage Policies" – with Tim Spilde
"Do ILEARN More? Retention, Resources, and Future Academic Attainment"

Research Experience

Research Assistant to Patrick Turner, University of Notre Dame — 2024–2026
Research Assistant to Niharika Singh, University of Notre Dame — 2023–2024
Research Assistant to Petros Ioannatos, Kettering University — 2020

Teaching Experience

Instructor, University of Notre Dame, Principles of Microeconomics 2024
Teaching Assistant, University of Notre Dame, LP Statistics for Economics 2023
Teaching Assistant, University of Notre Dame, Principles of Microeconomics 2022
Supplemental Instructor, Kettering University, Microeconomics I 2019
Supplemental Instructor, Kettering University, Calculus II 2018

Fellowships, Awards, and Affiliations

Notre Dame Program for Interdisciplinary Education Research (PIER) 2023–2027
Awarded annual $2,500 research stipend
Graduate Student Research Award 2024
Totaled $4,000
Wilson Sheehan Lab for Economic Opportunities Research Affiliate 2026–Present

Presentations

2026 - Notre Dame Applied Micro Brown Bag; Notre Dame Graduate Student Seminar; Association for Education Finance and Policy; Leuven Economics of Education Research; Association for Mentoring and Inclusion in Economics; MidSouth Education Policy (Scheduled); Midwest Economics of Education (Scheduled); Southern Economic Association (Scheduled); Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (Scheduled)

2025 - Notre Dame Applied Micro Brown Bag; Notre Dame Graduate Student Seminar; MidSouth Education Policy; Midwest Sociology of Education Conference

Work Experience

Actuarial Intern, Willis Towers Watson 2018–2020
Purchasing Assistant, LEER Corporation 2017–2018

Attributes and Skills

Computational Skills: Stata, LaTeX, Excel (Advanced) Matlab, Python, SPSS (proficient)

Applied Methods: RCT design, causal inference methods, value-added estimation, event studies

Federal Access, Credentials, & Compliance: U.S Census Bureau Special Sworn Status, Restricted-Use Federal Data Authorization

References

Jim Sullivan (Chair)
Professor of Economics
University of Notre Dame
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Jeffrey Denning
Associate Professor of Public Policy
University of Texas
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Patrick Turner
Assistant Professor of Economics
University of Notre Dame
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